> **Version 1: superseded.** Use `Y10_Assessor_Booklet_v2` and `Y10_Student_Paper_v2` (version 2, October 2026). This version is kept for reference only.

# Year 10 Admission Assessment: assessor booklet

| | |
|---|---|
| **Candidate name** | |
| **Date of birth** | |
| **Year group applied for** | |
| **Current school** | |
| **Date of assessment** | |
| **Assessor** | |

**Who this is for.** Students applying for **Year 10** (age 14 on 1 September), the first year of a **two-year IGCSE course**. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 8 (初二)**; a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 9 (初三). Ask the student and the family which grade and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs between textbooks and regions. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

**What it measures.** The student's level of English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E), their maths and science against the end of Key Stage 3 (the UK Year 9 curriculum), and, through the interview, who they are, their future plans and their suitability for the programme. Section 6 explains how to read the results together to judge **readiness for IGCSE study in English**.

## 1. At a glance

| Order | Task | Minutes | Who leads | Materials | Print |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Welcome | 2 | Assessor | | This booklet |
| 2 | Listening: 8 questions (8 marks) | 5 | Assessor reads the script (Section 3.1); a small group is fine | Student paper pages 2 to 3; pencil | Student paper |
| 3 | Reading paper: Parts A, B and C (24 marks) | 12 | Student works alone | Student paper pages 4 to 9 | |
| 4 | Writing: one task from two (16 marks) | 10 | Student works alone | Student paper pages 10 to 11 | |
| 5 | Break | 3 to 5 | | Water | |
| 6 | Maths: Section A Number problems, Section B Word problems and pictures (30 marks) | 20 | Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud | Student paper pages 12 to 17; pencil, rubber, ruler; **no calculator, no protractor** | |
| 7 | Science: 7 questions (10 marks) | 8 | Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud | Student paper pages 18 to 20 | |
| 8 | Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 9** | 15 | Interviewer, 1:1 | Sentence Reading Card (laminated); a plain card to cover sentences | Sentence Reading Record; Interview Record Years 7 to 10 |
| | **Total** | **about 70 to 75** | | A clock or timer | Candidate Summary and Decision |

Files: `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`, `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`, `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) can run at the same time with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 7) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is always 1:1.

## 2. Before you start

**Room.** Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them.

**Say (welcome):** "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. Do you have any questions before we start?"

**Access rules (the same in every year group)**

| | English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading) | Maths and science |
|---|---|---|
| Reading aloud | Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English. | Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture. |
| Chinese | Not used by staff. | If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. |
| Answers | In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0. | In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0. |
| Not yet taught | | If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics in the score summary. |

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them in the score summary.

**Stopping rules**

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it. Do not move them on to Parts B and C.
- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed.
- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it.

**Keeping the student at ease.** Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly.

## 3. English

### 3.1 Listening (5 minutes, 8 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Listening page. You will hear a short talk by an engineer on a careers day at a school. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read the questions." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the script. Wait

10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

**Read it twice at a natural, steady pace** (about the speed of a teacher talking to a class). At each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not slow down for key words, repeat sentences or explain anything.

**Script: Careers Day talk**

Good morning, everyone. My name is Dr Liu Yan, and I'm an engineer. I work for a company in Shenzhen that designs electric buses. Some of you probably came to school on one of our buses this morning. [pause]

When I was your age, I wasn't sure what I wanted to do. I was quite good at art, and I loved drawing. But my favourite subject was physics, because I always wanted to know how things worked. At the weekends, I took old radios apart and tried to put them back together. [pause]

After school, I studied engineering at university for four years. Then I worked in a battery factory for two years. Now I lead a team of twelve people. [pause] Our newest bus can travel three hundred kilometres before it needs charging, and it charges in about ninety minutes. [pause]

People often think engineers sit alone at a computer all day. In fact, I spend most of my time talking: to my team, to bus drivers, and to the people who use our buses. Last year, an older passenger told us the steps were too high. So we changed the design. Now the floor of the bus goes down when it stops. [pause]

My advice to you is simple. Don't be afraid of getting things wrong. I got a lot of things wrong with those old radios. My parents weren't always happy about that! [pause] My first battery design failed every test, too. But each time it failed, I learnt something new. And remember: being good at maths is useful, but being good at listening is just as important. Thank you. [pause]

**Answers** (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear.

| Q | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept, and what it tells you |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **B** (the bus) | | |
| 2 | **Physics** | | Art (she was good at art, but it was not her favourite); Maths (mentioned only at the end) |
| 3 | **B** (taking a radio apart) | | A (painting: she loved drawing, but that is not what she did at weekends) |
| 4 | **4** | four (years) | 2 (the years in the battery factory) |
| 5 | **12** | twelve | |
| 6 | **300** (km) | three hundred | 90 (the charging time in minutes) |
| 7 | **The radios might be broken, or not work again** | She broke them; she could not always put them back together; she got things wrong with the radios; she made a mess; it could be dangerous; they were worried about the radios | "She did not study"; "She liked art"; an answer about the bus |
| 8 | **To show that mistakes help you learn** | Do not be afraid of getting things wrong; failing is part of learning; each failure taught her something; even experts fail at first | "Because the battery was bad" with no idea of learning from it |

### Band guide

| Score | 0 to 2 | 3 to 4 | 5 to 6 | 7 | 8 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Listening band | A | B | C | D | E |

**What to look for**

- Questions 1 to 3 check the main points (art is a distractor in question 2); 4 to 6 need exact detail and include distractors (two years, ninety minutes); 7 and 8 need implied meaning and the speaker's purpose. The questions follow the order of the script. A student who gets 1 to 6 but not 7 and 8 follows the facts of a talk but not yet its point: usually C.
- The talk is close to the kind of listening IGCSE lessons need: a teacher or visitor speaking for two minutes without pictures. A score of 5 or less suggests the student will need visual support and key words written down in most lessons at first.
- Compare with listening in the interview. If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check.

## 3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, 24 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Reading page. There are three parts, A, B and C. Each part is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

**General rules.** Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "copy". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood (except question 14). Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

**Part A: café menu** (very accessible; picture support)

| Q | Answer | Marks | Also accept / notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 9:00 | 1 | 9 am; nine o'clock; 9. Do not accept 7:30 (that is Monday to Friday). |
| 2 | ¥32 | 1 | 32; 32 yuan |
| 3 | Tomato and egg noodles; Spring rolls | 2 | 1 mark for each correct tick, minus 1 for each wrong tick (minimum 0). |
| 4 | Tomato and egg noodles, **or** vegetable fried rice | 1 | Do not accept spicy tofu with rice (spicy) or spring rolls (a snack, not in "Noodles and rice"). |
| 5 | Monday to Friday, 14:00 to 17:00 | 1 | weekdays; 2 pm to 5 pm. Days and times both needed. |
| 6 | (Your) student card | 1 | student ID |
| 7 | Tell the staff before you order | 1 | tell the staff; tell the waiter; ask the staff |

**Part B: "The Mooncake Lesson"** (fiction, about two years below age level)

| Q | Answer | Marks | Also accept / notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | Three months | 1 | 3 months |
| 9 | A (large) bag of flour | 1 | flour |
| 10 | She was terrible at cooking | 1 | She was bad at cooking; she had burnt the rice. |
| 11 | He has to help every year | 1 | His grandma makes him help; he has done it many times; he did not choose to. Do not accept "he was tired" or "he was sad". |
| 12 | He was friendly, not making fun of her | 1 | kind; nice; he was laughing with her, not at her; he wanted to help |
| 13 | 3, 1, 4, 2 (from the top) | 1 | All three missing numbers correct. |
| 14 | grinned | 1 | Must be the copied word, spelt correctly. Do not accept "perfect" or "stared". |
| 15 | She felt welcome: she had made friends with her neighbours and shared the festival with them | 1 | Any one idea: new friends; kind neighbours; she belonged or was part of a family celebration; she did something new and it went well. Do not accept "because she ate a mooncake" alone. |

**Part C: "Ten Minutes of Nothing"** (non-fiction opinion article, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 14)

| Q | Skill | Answer | Marks | Also accept / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 16 | Retrieval | They reach for their phones | 1 | look at, pick up or use their phones |

| Q | Skill | Answer | Marks | Also accept / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 17 | Vocabulary in context | immediate | 1 | |
| 18 | Retrieval and understanding | That what we are doing is not satisfying, so we should look for something better | 1 | Either idea; "it is a signal to change what we are doing". Do not accept "that we are tired". |
| 19 | Retrieval | They thought of more ideas (more uses for the plastic cups) | 1 | were more creative; had more ideas. Do not accept "they copied numbers". |
| 20 | Fact and opinion | Fact, Opinion, Fact, Opinion | 2 | All four correct: 2. Three correct: 1. Two or fewer: 0. |
| 21 | Writer's purpose | To show that her idea is reasonable, not extreme: she is not against phones | 1 | to answer readers who think she wants to ban phones; to make her small suggestion seem easy; humour to keep the reader on her side, if linked to her point |
| 22 | Writer's purpose | To get the reader's attention and make them think about their own life | 1 | to involve or "hook" the reader; to make readers realise they never do nothing. Do not accept "because it is a question". |

**Band guide (use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)**

| Result | Band |
|---|---|
| Part A under 4 | **A** New to English |
| Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4 | **B** Early acquisition |
| Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3 | **C** Developing competence |
| Part C 3 to 5 | **D** Competent |
| Part C 6 to 8 | **E** Fluent |

**What to look for**

- **Strong readers** separate fact from opinion (question 20) and explain why a writer makes a choice (21 and 22). These are the skills IGCSE English and the humanities test most, so a Part C score of 6 or more is the best single sign of readiness for First Language English.
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy, Part C blank or copied lines that do not answer the question. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Parts B and C may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the sentence reading record.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out. IGCSE papers are long; a student who is accurate but very slow will need reading practice and, possibly, an access arrangement assessment if there is a specific need.

## 3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

**The tasks.** Task A (descriptive): describe a busy place (a market, a train station or a festival) so that the reader can see, hear and smell it. Task B (persuasive): an article for the school website on whether every student should volunteer for one week each year, with an opinion, reasons and examples. The plan is not marked.

**Score each criterion 0 to 4** (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

| Criterion | 0 | 2 | 4 (what a fluent 14 year old would do) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Content and organisation** | Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task. | Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the description is a list of things, or the article lists reasons without explaining them. | Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Description: a clear sense of place built up through the senses, a viewpoint or mood, a shape (for example moving through the place, or from morning to night). Article: a clear position, reasons developed with examples, some awareness of the other side, a conclusion; written for website readers. |

| Criterion | 0 | 2 | 4 (what a fluent 14 year old would do) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Vocabulary** | Isolated words, or only words from the prompt. | Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("many people", "very busy", "good"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because). | Wide and precise vocabulary chosen for effect (sounds, smells, movement; persuasive phrases); a range of linking words (however, moreover, as a result, although); some figurative language that works. |
| **Grammar and sentences** | No sentences. | Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb forms, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear. | A variety of sentence types used for effect, including complex sentences and some short sentences for impact; verb forms controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning. |
| **Spelling and punctuation** | Mostly impossible to read. | Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words. | Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; a range of punctuation (commas in lists and after openers, question marks, apostrophes, colons) used correctly. |

**Band by best fit**, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

| Band | Writing at Year 10 entry |
|---|---|
| **A** | Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese. |
| **B** | A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear. |
| **C** | A short connected piece (often 60 to 120 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing. |
| **D** | An organised piece (often 120 to 200 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary. |
| **E** | See below. |

**Band E writing at this age.** A fluent 14 year old usually writes 180 to 280 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with controlled, varied sentences, precise vocabulary chosen for its effect on the reader, and accurate spelling and punctuation. The description creates a mood rather than listing objects; the article argues, gives evidence and examples, and speaks directly to its reader. This is roughly the level a First Language English IGCSE course starts from.

#### What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Nowadays, with the development of society") or memorised essay phrases followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.
- For IGCSE, the gap between the writing band and the other bands matters: writing is assessed in almost every subject. If writing is two bands below reading, name it in the summary.

### 3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

Use `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10` for the interview and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record` for the sentence reading. Both are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 10 starts at **Level 9 (sentence 25)**. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring on the record. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block on the form, including **future plans and aspirations** and the **Year 10 only** questions about IGCSE subject choices and starting a two-year course in English. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English.

- **Speaking band:** circle it on the interview record, using the descriptors there, and copy it to the score summary below. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

## 4. Maths (20 minutes, 30 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Maths page. You have 20 minutes. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. You may not use a calculator. Do as much as you can, and look at every page." The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words Standard form, Expand, Make … the subject and Solve mean; it is there so that an English word does not hide maths the student knows.

**Sections.** Section A, **Number problems** (questions 1 to 7, 9 marks): calculation and algebra with no context. Section B, **Word problems and pictures** (questions 8 to 18, 21 marks): **word problems** (questions 8 to 11, 7 marks) and problems with diagrams, pictures and tables (questions 12 to 18, 14 marks). Questions 7 and 18(b) are ceiling items from the Year 10 (IGCSE) course; questions 1 and 8 are floor items.

**Marking.** M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark. A correct answer with no working gets full marks unless the scheme says otherwise. Units are not needed unless stated. Working in numbers and symbols is fine; any words must be in English.

**What a Year 10 entrant may not have been taught.** A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 8 (初二)**, so **algebra (expanding, factorising with common factors, indices, linear equations and simultaneous equations), Pythagoras and linear functions are often strong**. Chinese textbooks write a straight line as $y = kx + b$, not $y = mx + c$. Grade 9 topics **may not have been taught yet**: quadratic equations, similar triangles, trigonometry and probability with tree diagrams. Compound interest is often new too (primary school teaches simple interest). Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught: Grade 9 covers these topics, so a strong Grade 8 student usually catches up quickly.

| Q | Topic | Answer | Marks and partial credit | May not have been taught? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Section A** | **Number problems** | | | |
| 1 | Negative numbers and order of operations (floor) | 4 | B1. An answer of 44 ((−8 − 3) × (−4)) shows the order of operations is not secure; −20 is a sign error. | Secure (Grade 7). |
| 2 | Standard form | $4.6 \times 10^6$ | B1. Do not accept $46 \times 10^5$. | Secure (Grade 7, 科学记数法). |
| 3 | Laws of indices | $x^6$ | B1 | Secure (Grade 8, 幂的运算). |
| 4 | Rearranging a formula | $x = (y + 5) \div 3$ | B1. Accept $x = y/3 + 5/3$ and equivalents. | Secure (Grades 7 to 8). |
| 5 | Expanding double brackets | $x^2 + 2x - 8$ | B2. B1 for $x^2 - 2x + 4x - 8$ with at most one error, or for $x^2 + 2x$ with a wrong number term. | Secure (Grade 8, 整式的乘法). |
| 6 | Simultaneous equations | $x = 4$, $y = 3$ | M1 for adding the equations ($3x = 12$) or a correct substitution; A1 for both values. Both values found by trial and correct: 2. | Secure (Grade 7, 二元一次方程组). |
| 7 | Solving a quadratic by factorising (ceiling) | $x = 2$ or $x = 3$ | B1 for both values. If $(x - 2)(x - 3)$ is seen without the solutions: 0, but note "factorises quadratics". | Grade 9 (一元二次方程): may not have been taught. Factorising $x^2 + px + q$ (十字相乘法) is taught in some Grade 8 classes only. |
| **Section B** | **Word problems** | | | |

| Q | Topic | Answer | Marks and partial credit | May not have been taught? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | Percentage of an amount (one step) | 180 | B1 | Secure (Grade 6). |
| 9 | Reverse percentage, money | ¥450 | M1 for 360 ÷ 0.8, or 360 ÷ 80 × 100, or "80% = 360"; A1 for 450. An answer of 432 (360 × 1.2) scores 0: it shows the student increased the sale price by 20% instead of working back. | Secure (Grade 6: finding the whole from a percentage). |
| 10 | Compound interest, money | ¥5408 | M1 for 5200 (after one year), or 5000 × $1.04^2$, or 5000 × 1.0816; A1 for 5408. An answer of 5400 (simple interest) scores 0: note it. | Compound interest may not have been taught (primary teaches simple interest, 利率). |
| 11 | Average speed with a time calculation | 280 km per hour | M1 for 4.5 hours, or 4 hours 30 minutes, or 270 minutes, or 1260 ÷ 4.5; A1 for 280. An answer of about 293 (using 4.3 hours) scores 0: a time conversion error. | Secure (primary and Grade 8 physics). |
| **Section B** | **Diagrams, pictures and tables** | | | |
| 12 | Circumference; volume of a cylinder | (a) 31.4 cm (b) 785 $cm^3$ | B1 each. Accept 10π and 250π. (b) An answer of 3140 (using the diameter) scores 0. | Secure (Grade 6). |
| 13 | Pythagoras' theorem (shorter side) | 6 m | M1 for $6.5^2 - 2.5^2$, or 42.25 − 6.25, or 36; A1 for 6. An answer near 7 (adding the squares) scores 0. | Secure (Grade 8, 勾股定理). |
| 14 | Gradient and *y*-intercept | $y = 2x - 3$ | B1 for the gradient 2, B1 for the intercept −3 (each can be shown in a wrong equation, for example $y = 2x + 3$ scores 1). | Secure (Grade 8, 一次函数; the student may write *k* and *b*). |
| 15 | Estimated mean from grouped data | 18.5 minutes | M1 for using the midpoints 5, 15, 25 and 35 (20 + 120 + 125 + 105 = 370) or 370 ÷ 20; A1 for 18.5. Using the upper class limits (470 ÷ 20 = 23.5) scores 0. | Usually secure: Grade 8 statistics uses class midpoints (组中值) to estimate a mean. |
| 16 | Similar triangles | 12 cm | M1 for the scale factor 1.5, or 9 ÷ 6, or 8 × 9 ÷ 6; A1 for 12. An answer of 11 (adding 3) shows additive rather than multiplicative thinking. | Grade 9 (相似): may not have been taught, but ratio from primary school often helps. |
| 17 | Tree diagram | (a) 0.8 (Monday not late), 0.8 (Tuesday not late after late), 0.2 and 0.8 (Tuesday after not late) (b) 0.04 | (a) B1 for all four. (b) B1. Accept 4/100, 1/25, 4%. An answer of 0.4 (adding) scores 0. | Grade 9 (概率, 树状图): may not have been taught. |
| 18 | Trigonometry with given values | (a) 5.7 cm (b) 37° | (a) B1 for 5.7 (accept 5.74 or 10 × 0.57). (b) B1 for 37° (ceiling: finding an angle). An answer of 53° in (b) means opposite and adjacent were swapped. | Grade 9 (锐角三角函数): may not have been taught. |

**Totals:** Section A / 9, Section B / 21 (of which word problems, questions 8 to 11: / 7). **Band guide** (provisional): 0 to 11: **1** Well below expected; 12 to 17: **2** Working towards; 18 to 25: **3** Expected; 26 to 30: **4** Greater depth. Every Year 10 topic in the blueprint is tested at least once.

**What to look for**

- **Number problems against word problems.** A student who scores well on Section A but poorly on the word problems (questions 8 to 11) may have an **English barrier rather than a maths difficulty**. Check by reading the word problem aloud in English, and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark it L). If the student then solves it quickly, record the barrier. IGCSE maths papers are full of words, so this student needs maths vocabulary support, not a lower tier.
- **Strong responses** show secure algebra (Section A almost complete), clear working and correct units, and attempts at the Grade 9 topics. A student with 7 or more out of 9 in Section A is usually ready for the Extended (Higher) tier once the Grade 9 topics are taught (Section 6).
- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (negative numbers, percentages, equations, Pythagoras), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions (7, 10, 16, 17, 18), write the likely band once taught in the summary.

## 5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

**What a Year 10 entrant may not have been taught.** In Chinese middle schools, biology runs from Grade 7, physics starts in Grade 8 (motion and speed, force, pressure, simple machines and efficiency) and chemistry only in Grade 9. A Year 10 entrant has usually done **biology and some physics but no chemistry**. Questions 6 and 7 may not have been taught: mark NT rather than reading this as weak science, and judge scientific thinking from question 4.

| Q | Topic | Answer | Marks and partial credit | May not have been taught? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Specialised cells | B (root hair cell) | B1 | Usually secure (Grade 7 biology: cells, roots, blood). |
| 2 | Distance-time graph and speed | (a) He stopped (not moving) (b) 6 m/s | (a) B1: stopped; waiting; at traffic lights. Do not accept "going slowly". (b) B1 for 6 (1200 ÷ 200). | Secure (Grade 8 physics, 速度 and distance-time graphs). |
| 3 | Pressure | 300 N/m² | B1. Accept 300 Pa. An answer of 1200 (600 × 2) scores 0. | Secure (Grade 8 physics, 压强). |
| 4 | Factors affecting photosynthesis: pattern, variables, evaluating a method | (a) The further away the lamp, the fewer bubbles (b) One control variable (c) One sensible improvement | (a) B1: must link both variables (closer means more bubbles is fine). (b) B1: the same pondweed, the same water temperature, the same volume of water, the same lamp or bulb, the same counting time. Do not accept "distance" or "number of bubbles". (c) B1: repeat each distance and find a mean; count for longer; collect and measure the gas instead of counting bubbles (bubbles differ in size); keep the temperature the same (the lamp heats the water). | Photosynthesis is secure (Grade 7 biology). Evaluating a method is less familiar: score what the student writes. |
| 5 | Efficiency | 0.75 | B1. Accept 75% and 3/4. An answer of 150 or 1.33 scores 0. | Usually secure (Grade 8 physics, 机械效率), although energy transfer diagrams may be new. |
| 6 | Atomic structure | 7 | B1 (3 protons + 4 neutrons). An answer of 3 (protons only) or 10 (all particles) scores 0. | Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught. |

| Q | Topic | Answer | Marks and partial credit | May not have been taught? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | Balancing an equation | 2 | B1 | Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught, but the particle picture lets a student count atoms. |

**Band guide** (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

**Not tested this year** (not enough time): diffusion, groups in the periodic table, rates of reaction, energy resources, waves, DNA and inheritance. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for subject choices.

**What to look for**

- **Working scientifically** (question 4) is the best guide to IGCSE science readiness: a student who describes a pattern, names a control variable and suggests a real improvement is ready for practical work in English, even with chemistry NT.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud. Science vocabulary in English (specialised, efficiency, variable, mass number) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know.
- **Strong responses** use units (m/s, N/m$^2$) and give precise answers in question 4 (for example "repeat three times and calculate a mean").

## 6. Readiness for IGCSE

**This section is guidance for the school to confirm**, against its own admissions policy, the IGCSE syllabuses it offers (for example Cambridge IGCSE or Pearson Edexcel International GCSE), the entry requirements of its own sixth form or diploma programme, and the support it can provide. It is not a set of fixed rules. Fill in the score summary (Section 7) first, then read the results together.

**English is the gateway.** Every IGCSE subject except other languages is taught and examined in English, with long texts, extended written answers and command words such as describe, explain and evaluate. Look at the overall English band, and most closely at **reading and writing**, because the exams depend on them. Academic English usually develops more slowly than conversation: as a planning assumption, a student rarely moves up more than about one band a year in academic reading and writing, even with good support. A student at band C at the start of Year 10 may still be at C or D when the exams come.

| English band | What it usually means for IGCSE study in English | English course that may fit best |
|---|---|---|
| **A** New to English | Cannot yet follow subject lessons in English. Direct entry to a two-year IGCSE course is not usually advisable (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9). | A preparatory or foundation route, or a later start, if the school has one. |
| **B** Early acquisition | Can follow simple, supported lessons, but IGCSE texts and exam questions will be very hard for most of Year 10. | Only with an English as a Second Language course, a reduced subject load and close review, if the school's policy allows. |
| **C** Developing competence | Can follow most lessons with support; subject vocabulary and extended writing will slow progress. Maths and the sciences are usually more accessible than essay-based subjects. | **English as a Second Language**, with support for subject language. |
| **D** Competent | Usually ready for IGCSE courses taught in English, with some support for academic writing. | English as a Second Language at the higher level, or First Language English if reading **and** writing are strong D or E. Check with the English department. |
| **E** Fluent | Ready for IGCSE study in English. | **First Language English** (and English Literature, if offered). |

**What English band does a student realistically need?** As a working guide for the school to test: **band C or above in reading and writing**, with listening and speaking at C or above, to follow IGCSE courses taught in English with support, and **band D or above** to follow them with little extra support. Review these thresholds once the first groups of students have taken their IGCSEs.

**English as a Second Language or First Language English?** First Language English assumes the reading and writing of a fluent speaker: analysing how writers use language, and writing at length for different purposes. It is usually the better fit only when reading (Part C 6 or more) and writing (band E, or a strong D) are both near fluent. For most students at band C or D, an English as a Second Language course is the better fit: it teaches the reading, writing, listening and speaking needed for study, and a good grade is more achievable. Check what the school's sixth form, diploma programme and likely universities ask for, because some ask for a particular course or grade; tell the family early.

**Maths.** Band 3 or 4 with a secure Section A (7 or more out of 9) suggests the **Extended (Higher) tier**. NT marks on the Grade 9 topics (quadratics, similar triangles, trigonometry, tree diagrams, compound interest) are expected for a Grade 8 student and are usually caught up quickly. A band 2 with errors on taught topics suggests the Core (Foundation) tier at first, with a learning plan and a review after one term. A band 1 that NT and English do not explain (low on taught topics too) needs further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9). A large gap between number problems and word problems points to English support in maths, not a lower tier.

**Science.** No chemistry is normal for this age group (questions 6 and 7 NT). Look at question 4 and the biology and physics questions. Strong science (band 3 or 4) with English D or E may suit separate sciences; with English B or C, a combined or co-ordinated science course, or fewer science subjects in the first year, may be more manageable while English grows.

**Reading the results together** (examples of common profiles)

| Profile | What it suggests | A possible plan (for the school to confirm) |
|---|---|---|
| English D or E; maths 3 or 4; science 3 or 4 (allowing for NT) | Ready for a full IGCSE programme. | Full subject load; English course by the table above; Extended maths. |
| English C; maths 3 or 4, with word problems well below number problems | Strong maths; English is the barrier. | English as a Second Language with subject-language support; Extended maths with vocabulary support; not too many essay-based subjects in Year 10. |
| English C; maths 2 with NT on Grade 9 topics; chemistry NT | Likely to manage with support. | English as a Second Language; a learning plan for the NT maths topics and for chemistry; maths tier decided after a six-week review. |
| English B, any maths and science | The English gap is too wide for most IGCSE content in two years without intensive support. | Offer only with an English as a Second Language course, a reduced subject load and close review, if the school's policy allows; otherwise discuss a preparatory route or a later start (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9). |
| English D or E; maths band 1 on taught topics | Not an English issue. | Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9): look for gaps in earlier learning or a possible learning need. If an offer follows, maths support and the Core tier at first. |
| Strong results, but the interview shows the IGCSE plan is the family's, not the student's | Readiness is not only academic. | Talk with the family and student about subject choices and workload before an offer (interview record, suitability strands). A serious mismatch, or any strand rated 1, goes to the head of section before any offer. |

Use the Year 10 interview questions (IGCSE subject choices, managing a two-year course in English) to judge whether the student's plans are realistic and their own. Record the readiness judgement in the assessor's comment below and on the Candidate Summary and Decision.

## 7. Score summary

Copy to `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

| Part | Score | Band | Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Listening | ___ / 8 | A B C D E | |
| Reading paper | ___ / 24 (A ___ / 8, B ___ / 8, C ___ / 8) | A B C D E | |
| Sentence reading (shared record) | points ___ / 72; reading age _____ | indicative:<br>A B C D E | Meaning checks:<br>Fluency: |
| Writing (task A or B) | ___ / 16 (content ___, vocabulary ___, grammar ___, spelling and punctuation ___) | A B C D E | |
| Speaking (from the interview) | | A B C D E | |
| Maths | ___ / 30 (A ___ / 9, B ___ / 21, of which word problems ___ / 7) | 1 2 3 4 | NT:<br><br>L: |
| Science | ___ / 10 | 1 2 3 4 | NT:<br><br>L: |
| **Overall English** (the band most skills sit in; name any skill two or more bands lower) | | A B C D E | |
| **Readiness for IGCSE** (Section 6) | English course: ESL / First Language / to decide<br>Maths tier: Extended / Core / to decide | Ready / Ready with support / Not yet | |

**Assessor's comment** (strengths, English barrier or not, NT topics and the likely maths and science band once taught, readiness for IGCSE, anything to follow up):

**Assessor signature and date** _____